

We now have two candidate facts, either of which might make trouble for the reality of free will.

Fate: there are
truths about
everything you
will do in the
future.

Foreknowledge:
God knows
everything about
what you will do
in the future.

One might of course accept the reality of fate without
accepting the reality of foreknowledge.

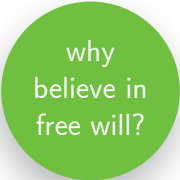
Our question is: do either fate or foreknowledge pose a serious challenge to the reality of free will?



two
arguments
against free
will



is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out

We now have two candidate facts, either of which might

make trouble for the reality of free will.





One might consider the reality of fate without

accepting the reality of foreknowledge.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predict.

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

either.

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

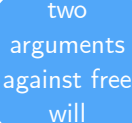
So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

things as fate, then there is no free will.

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Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

freedom that comes from fate.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

first let's think about how Edwards'

We'll shortly consider some ways of

responding to Edwards' argument. But

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Suppose that someone did not believe in

actions. Could they give an argument

there were truths about all our future

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

similar to Edwards' argument?

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

with reference to the being of truth about

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.



1. We have no direct facts.

acaioid.

then we have the choice about q.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

all of our activities.

perform a certain action (1,2)

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

2* In the past, there were truths about

5* We have noticed that the fact

God knows that in the future I will



0 We have achieved what we

will perform various actions.

some action, then I will prefer that

3 We have not the fact that

that if it is true that I will perform

(3, 4, 5)

The fatalist argument